🌟 Hope, Purpose & Wonder: Reading

Health · Unit 7 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Hope, Purpose & Wonder module (Hope = goals + pathways + willpower, Legacy Treasure Map, Purpose, Takeaways)

Name: _____

Hope, Purpose and Wonder

Psychologists who study hope describe it as a way of thinking with three parts: goals (what you want), pathways (the routes you can take to get there) and willpower, sometimes called agency (the energy and belief that you can keep going). Hope is not the same as wishing. Research shows that hope can be learned and grown, and people with more hope tend to cope better with stress and do better in school and work.

Strong goals are specific, measurable and have a time frame. “Do better in school” is vague; “turn in every Health assignment this month” is specific. Pathways thinking means planning for obstacles before they happen and having a Plan B. Asking for help is also a pathway. Willpower grows through positive self-talk, celebrating small wins and remembering past times you succeeded.

Purpose is a sense that what you do matters to you and helps others. Imagining yourself at age 40, with your work, relationships, community and the kind of person you want to be, can help you choose goals today that lead there. A legacy is how you want to be remembered and what you give to others.

The Legacy Treasure Map is a way to plan: the treasure is a big goal, rocks and rivers are obstacles, trails are pathways around them, and helpers are the people and resources that support you. Wonder, feeling amazed by nature, music, art or science, lowers stress and can renew hope.

This course covered many dimensions of health: wellness and decision-making, nutrition, substance use, social-emotional skills, sexual health, and safety and first aid. Each unit gave tools for making choices that match your values. If hope ever feels out of reach, help is available from trusted adults, the school counselor and 988 (call or text).

Check your reading

1. What are the three parts of hope?

2. How is hope different from wishing?

3. Rewrite “get in shape” as a specific goal.